

CASE REVIEW — SARN AND BALLARD (DECEASED)

On the night of 18 November, Storm Bettany closed the road to Ravensgate Dam and six people were sealed in with each other until the following afternoon. By dawn two of them were dead.

Aurelio Sarn, the Station Manager, was electrocuted in the turbine hall at 06:03. Ines Ballard, a Control Engineer, was found drowned at 07:25 in the intake gallery. Ms Ballard's credential card had opened the cabinet Mr Sarn died at, and had closed the circuit that killed him.

The police concluded murder–suicide and closed the file in nineteen days.

The Reservoirs & Dam Safety Inspectorate does not agree, on a technical point about water, and has said so in writing. This review is convened because two competent authorities have reached findings that cannot both be true.

YOUR TASK

You are the review team. Between you, you hold every file both enquiries generated — but no one of you holds all of it.

Establish what happened at Ravensgate. If the original finding is wrong, say so, say who, and show your working.

WHAT IS DIFFERENT ABOUT THIS CASE

The file is split. The Case Board in the middle of the table is public and belongs to everybody. Everything else is in five Specialist Files, and each of you holds one. You may not read another detective's file. You may not pass it across. You may only **table** what you choose to table, when you choose to.

This is not a game of hidden traitors. Nobody at this table is lying to anybody. Every one of you wants the same answer. The difficulty is that the answer is in five pieces and the pieces do not know about each other.

A WARNING ABOUT A DEAD WOMAN

This review begins with a conclusion already reached about Ines Ballard, who is not here to argue with it. Nineteen days of police work say she killed a man and then drowned herself. If you decide they were right, say so — that is a legitimate finding and you may write it down.

Just be sure it is a finding and not an inheritance.

THE CASE CONFERENCE

1 · WHO HOLDS WHAT

DETECTIVES ALLOCATION OF THE FIVE SPECIALIST FILES

2	F-1 + F-3 / F-2 + F-4 + F-5 (two Sessions, not three)
3	F-1 + F-3 / F-2 / F-4 + F-5
4	F-1 / F-2 / F-3 + F-4 / F-5
5	One file each
6	One file each, and a sixth detective as CASE OFFICER — holds no file, keeps the Board and the Resolution Sheet, and may query but never table

Solo play does not use the Conference. See the reverse of the Resolution Sheet.

2 · THREE SESSIONS

The review proceeds in **three Sessions**. Take a breath between them; they are not timed.

In each Session, each detective may TABLE one document from a file they hold. To table it: read it aloud, then lay it face up on the Case Board. It is public from that moment and stays public.

One document. Per detective. Per Session. Choose it well — and notice that what is worth tabling in Session 3 is not what was worth tabling in Session 1.

3 · THE QUERY

At any moment, any detective may **QUERY**: name a subject, a piece of plant, a person or a clock time.

Every other detective must answer truthfully whether their file holds anything on it. Yes or no. They need not say what it is, and tabling it still costs a Session slot.

Queries are free and unlimited. Asking the right question is the skill this case is testing.

4 · AUTHORITIES

Between Sessions — never during one — the table may spend from a shared pool of Authorities, exactly as in Case 01. Twelve lines of inquiry are listed overleaf.

DETECTIVES AUTHORITIES

1 – 2	5
3 – 4	6
5 – 6	7

5 · AFTER SESSION 3

All files open. Everything is shared, everyone reads everything, and the review reaches its finding with the whole file in front of it.

But: each step of the Case Resolution Sheet **scores double** if it was established on the Case Board *before the end of Session 3*. Reaching the right answer after everything is face up is worth something. Reaching it while the file was still in pieces is worth twice as much.

6 · ACCUSING

Two wrong accusations are permitted; each costs 10 points and returns a **Reconsider** envelope. **Your third accusation is final.** Then, and only then, open **Envelope S-1**.

OPEN LINES OF INQUIRY

Twelve authorities. Each may be exercised once. Spend only between Sessions. Tick the box, then open the matching sealed slip.

SPENT	NO.	AUTHORITY	DIRECTED TO
☐	01	Obtain the console 1 alarm acknowledgement log	Cairnhold operations
☐	02	Scene property and credential audit — where was each card recovered?	County Constabulary
☐	03	Re-interview C. Mbeki regarding the spare control room key	CID
☐	04	Trash rack differential-pressure trace and debris analysis	Cairnhold civil
☐	05	Second post-mortem on I. Ballard, independent pathologist	OCME
☐	06	Financial disclosure — H. Vey and associated entities	Financial Investigation Unit
☐	07	As-built amendment history and the RG-0419 decommissioning certificate	Cairnhold engineering records
☐	08	Recover the 02:25 argument — who overheard it, and what was said	CID
☐	09	Full movement reconciliation for P. Wrenn (RDSI officer)	CRU
☐	10	Metallurgical examination of the C-14 contact surfaces	Forensic science
☐	11	Thennick Instrumentation Ltd — corporate and delivery records	Companies registry
☐	12	Forebay parapet examination — fibre, contact traces, damage	Forensic science

AUTHORITIES REMAINING



Use only as many boxes as your table is entitled to — five, six or seven. There are twelve authorities and you cannot have half of them.

ADVICE FROM THE UNIT

Four of these twelve return nothing you do not already have. They are not traps; they are the ordinary shape of an investigation, and the skill is telling them apart from the others *before* you pay. Every authority worth buying was suggested by a document somebody has already tabled. If nobody at the table can point to that document, do not buy it yet — **query first**. Queries are free.

CASE RESOLUTION SHEET

Cite by document reference (B-2, D-2A, SLIP 04). Tick S≤3 if the step was established on the Case Board before the end of Session 3 — those steps score double.

1. 1 · THE TWO CAUSES OF DEATH

Evidence S≤3

2. 2 · WHEN DID INES BALLARD ENTER THE WATER — AND BY WHAT ARGUMENT?

Evidence S≤3

3. 3 · WHAT DOES A CREDENTIAL EVENT ACTUALLY PROVE?

Evidence S≤3

4. 4 · MECHANISM — WHY DID A CORRECT ISOLATION FAIL TO PROTECT HIM?

Evidence S≤3

5. 5 · OPPORTUNITY — WHO COULD HAVE USED HER CARD, AND FROM WHERE?

Evidence S≤3

6. 6 · CONTRADICTION — WHOSE ACCOUNT OF THAT NIGHT FAILS?

Evidence S≤3

PERSONS

PERSON	FINDING	EVIDENCE RELIED ON
BALLARD, Ines named by the original finding		
VEY, Halloran Shift Control Engineer		
OKONKWO, Dessa Maintenance Technician		
WRENN, Piotr RDSI officer		
MBEKI, Cato Assistant Operator		

MOTIVE

AUTHORITIES

ENTITLED TO	SPENT
NUMBERS USED	UNSPENT

ACCUSATIONS

NO.	NAMED	TIME	OUTCOME
1			
2			
3	—		

FINAL

FINDING OF THE REVIEW

The deaths of Aurelio Sarn and Ines Ballard are found to be:

☐ MURDER-SUICIDE, AS ORIGINALLY FOUND

☐ DOUBLE UNLAWFUL KILLING

☐ OTHER (state)

If unlawful killing by a third party, that person is:

SIGNED, LEAD REVIEWERTIME

SOLO PLAY — PHASED RELEASE

No Conference. Five Authorities. Open one file per phase, in this order, and write a hypothesis before opening the next.

PHASE	OPEN	BEFORE MOVING ON, WRITE DOWN
1	Case Board only	Which of the two deaths came first, and why you think so
2	+ File F-2 (Hydrology)	A time window for Ballard entering the water
3	+ File F-1 (Control)	Who could have been at console 1 at 06:02
4	+ File F-4 (Security)	Where her credential card was, and who could reach it
5	+ Files F-3 and F-5	— accuse

Authorities may be spent from Phase 2 onward.

NOW OPEN ENVELOPE S-1